

 Department of Children & Family Services <i>Building a Stronger Louisiana</i>	Division/Section	Family Support
	Chapter No./Name	4 – Economic Stability (ES)
	Part No./Name	B – Eligibility Factors
	Section No./Name	B-800-FITAP Relationship
	Document No./Name	B-820-FITAP Required Verification
	Effective Date	May 1, 2024

I. STATEMENT OF POLICY

Verify relationship of each child to the qualified relative at certification and when adding a child.

B-821-FITAP - PO HOW TO VERIFY RELATIONSHIP TO PARENT

Relationship of a child to his parent(s) is primarily verified through a birth certificate. If the birth certificate is not available, other documents may be used if they include the name of the child and the parent(s). These documents may include:

- baptismal certificate,
- documents from the United States Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS) and/or identifying information provided in correspondence from a Voluntary Agency,
- licensed midwife records, or
- medical records.

Note: A birth card which does not include the full name of the child, full name of the mother and/or father is not sufficient verification of relationship. Other supporting documentation as outlined above and at B-822-FITAP must be obtained.

If the father's name does not appear on the birth certificate, the determination of his relationship to the child may be established by one or more of the following:

- a court judgment which declares the man to be the child's father;
- documentation that the child receives financial benefits based on circumstances of the father, i.e., Social Security, VA, military allotment;
- documentation that the child is claimed by the man as his dependent child for income tax purposes;
- paternity test results that verify the man to be the father; or
- the man is named by the mother and:
 - the man verbally acknowledges paternity to the agency, or
 - the man signs an acknowledgement of paternity, or
 - at least two references or collaterals state in writing that the man has acknowledged to them that he is the child's father.

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B-822-FITAP - PO HOW TO VERIFY RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER QUALIFIED RELATIVE

Once the parental relationship has been established, use documentary proof to establish the child's relationship to the qualified relative. In addition to the documents listed in section B-821-FITAP, the following may be used:

- family bible,
- church records,
- U.S. Census records,
- insurance policies over 3 years old, or
- legal document executed by the court, such as a custody order, which states the qualified relative's relationship to the child.

If none of the above documents is available, the relationship of the qualified relative to the child may be established by securing:

- the qualified relative's written statement as to how he is related to the child, and
- a written statement attesting to the relationship from another individual in a position to know the facts of the situation.

Determine how the collateral is knowledgeable of the client's situation and document this *** in Case Notes. If the collateral is not interviewed in the parish office, contact the collateral by telephone to obtain the documentation of how he knows of the relationship of the qualified relative to the child.

II. PROCEDURES

To request verification of Relationship, select '*Pending Verification*' or '*Client Statement*' on the **Relationship – Details** screen for those relationships that have not been verified.

To avoid a request for verification for household members in error, select '*Reliable Reference*' as the relationship verification type when documentation is available for one of the members and not the other member as relationship has not been verified between those household members.

Example: Mother applies for herself and two children. The agency has a birth certificate for the first child only. LITE is updated to reflect the birth certificate contained in OnBase for that child. However, verification is still needed for the second child. Data collection in LITE on the **Relationship – Details** chart would be updated as follows:

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Between Mother and 1st child – Relationship Verification coding should be '*Birth Certificate*.'

Between Mother and 2nd child – Relationship Verification coding should be '*Pending Verification*' or '*Client Statement*' if there is an associated SNAP case.

Between the 1st child and 2nd child – Relationship verification coding should be '*Reliable Reference*.'

If '*Pending Verification*' is selected as the relationship verification between the two children, LITE will also request verification for the 1st child. This would be incorrect as there is already a birth certificate on file for the 1st child.

NOTE: Conversion codes (data from legacy systems) must be reviewed and updated accordingly. LITE cannot determine correct relationships and eligibility if '*Conversion Value*' is not updated to reflect the correct household situation.

* Paternity Establishment and Support Enforcement (PESE)

The PESE interface allows access to Vital Records to receive and verify birth record information that assists in establishing relationship for program applicants. Staff is allowed to view birth record information if provisioned in the Case Access role. Staff may use PESE to establish the relationship status and/or age of household members. PESE must be reviewed prior to requesting verification of relationship. PESE information can be accessed in LITE by two methods: by using the PESE *On-*

Demand button  in the '*Case Info*' right navigation panel in the case record or by clicking the PESE button from the '*Internal Links*' left navigation panel on the LITE Home screen.

The PESE *On-Demand* button is displayed on the following screens within a case record in LITE from the '*Case Info*' right navigation panel:

- Person – Details
- Relationship – Details, and
- Person Demographics – Details

To access the PESE via the *On-Demand* button, the *Person - Details*, *Relationship - Details*, or the *Person Demographics - Details* screens to conduct a search, the worker must:

- Click the PESE *On-Demand* button from the '*Case Info*' right navigation panel to display the PESE website's Search screen with the results pre-populated for the individual whose details are being reviewed.
- If staff have not received authorization to access PESE, clicking the *On-Demand* button will result in being redirected to the PESE website with the following error message displayed: "*You are not authorized to access this site. Please contact system administrator.*"

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PESE is also available as a Single Sign-On (SSO) that is accessed from the LITE Home Page within the *Internal Links* left navigation panel.

To access the PESE via the LITE Home Page and conduct a search, the worker must:

- Navigate to the LITE Worker Portal (WP) Home screen,
- Click the *PESE* link from the left '*Internal Links*' panel on the WP Home screen to be redirected to the PESE website,

On the Search screen, enter the first and last names, dates of birth, and Social Security Numbers of the parents and child in the designated fields and click 'Search' to display available records.

If relationship is verified through PESE, document the case with a case note and enter the birth certificate number in the Document Type/Number column on the family tree in LITE. **

III. FORMS AND INSTRUCTIONS

There are no forms and instructions associated with this policy.

IV. REFERENCES

[Title IV of the Social Security Act, Sec. 408](#)

[LAC 67:II.1227](#)